

Rodney Amateur Radio Club – Branch #71

<http://zl1rod.org/>

President of the Branch #71 NZART - PO BOX 404101 PUHOI 0951



President's

ANNUAL REPORT

FY 2018

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FOREWORD

Puhoi, February 2019

Dear Members and Affiliated

I thank you for the confidence shown to me for the past year!

I would like to write a few lines talking about all of us, reviewing the past year, and have a quick look-out into 2019.

Foremost – I especially want to thank and express our gratitude to

- The Wellsford Library and its staff members for providing us a great meeting location.
- Roger Davis for hosting our repeater site.
- Ron Crawley and Gary Ball for sponsoring our domain name and running our homepage.
- Individual members and visitors who gave generous donations to the club.
- All XYLs for coping with their partners who spend lots of time with the Club and hobby, hanging wires in the garden and the trees, interfering with the TV reception and sometimes adjusting their bed time to the HF propagation cycles.

It is the generous support of all of you that makes it possible to keep our Club operating

Thank you for your trust and confidence you've had in me and I hope you have enjoyed the past year with the RARC!

I wish you and your family a healthy, happy and successful 2019!

Yours truly,

Paul Kaufmann– ZL1PAK

President of the Rodney Amateur Radio Club, Branch #71 NZART

CLUB MEMBERS

Club Members

Currently we count 18 members

We have welcomed 1 HAM as a new member:

- Bert Toomey – ZL1AQX

Sadly some of our members' akin passed away:

- Gavin's Mother
- Roger Davis' Wife

We send our deepest sympathy to Gavin and Roger.

At our monthly meetings we usually meet with around 6-10 members.

Some members have a long drive to join the meeting but come regularly.

Many thanks to all of you who take the time and distance for coming to our meetings - your presence and participation help us to keep the Club operating!

FINANCES

Finances

We have a positive amount of money in our bank accounts and no outstanding payments. Numbers and details are provided as usual via our monthly newsletters.

I suggest the following BUDGET for the coming year 2019:

<u>IN:</u>	
-15x Membership Fee:	300.-- to 375.-- (depending on subscription fees)
-??? Donations:	100.-- (estimated annual average)

<u>OUT:</u>	
-License Fee:	50.--
-Stationary, Postage, Gifts:	180.--
-Library Meeting Room Fees:	115.--
-Repairs and unexpected expenditures	300.--

With all the expenses paid we will expect a LOSS of about 170-to-270 Dollars. That money will be taken out from the bank accounts.

If there are no unexpected expenditures and lots of donations then we might even get a positive value (gain) of about 150 Dollars.

My thanks go to Paul S. – ZL1VPS, our treasurer who manages all our cheque payments, expenses, bank accounts, book keeping and monthly reports.

REVIEWING 2018

Reviewing 2018

We had a good start into the year and we had a well-attended AGM in February. 11 members were present.

We have elected for Paul (me), staying as President – Andrew for Secretary – Alan as Entertainment and Education Officer – Mike and Richard as our Repeater Trustees #1 and #2 - Cecil to be Honourable Repeater Trustee #3 - Richard for Official Contact Person - Paul Sole as Treasurer and AREC contact. Paul (me) to provide a Post Office Box for Club usage. Signature holders will stay with Paul Sole and Paul Kaufmann (Treasurer and President).

We unanimously agreed for the annual subscription fee to be NZD20.— and we have discounted the subscription fee for Ron to reward him for his great work with sponsoring the domain name and web hosting for our Club (ZL1ROD.org).

Andrew our Secretary did a lot of work for us in the background. It is quite remarkable how well he is supporting us.

Andrew makes sure that we have a topical members' list, all the licence fees paid, sends all emails and invites to everyone, maintains and updates addresses and various other data. He is also liaising with NZART and keeps contacts to other HAMs.

Our end of year appreciation gift basket was a nice surprise and very welcomed by the Library staff. It was filled with chocolate, cookies, lottery tickets and handcrafted soap.



Roger Davis the landowner of our repeater site received a bottle of his favourite Whisky and a shaving soap. He was very happy and sends us his thanks to all R.A.R.C. members.



We explained the Library staff and Roger that they are great support for us and we highly appreciate their generous help.



The year started very well with our Club having a new antenna that seems to outperform all the past installations we had.

Also we had Gary and Ron joining forces and bringing out our new Webpage. This new Webpage is a great asset and I cannot imagine how we ever could live without it. It is a great source of information and a great "business card" for our Club. Gary is moderating and maintaining it very professionally.

There are a lot of good information found at our webpage and we even have received (email) compliments from the public and independent people abroad.

Ross has provided a 24/7 online Web-SDR station online (<http://sdr.med.co.nz:8073>). The link can also be found on our webpage.

Thanks to Ross' SDR stations I can listen to Gavin and John and many others chatting on HF. So I can listen to HF even without having my own rig being on the air.

There is also great progress with bringing a new life to the old spare repeater and duplexer and we will be using them for emergencies and temporary use. Ross took it all aboard, spent some good time and space for it and also organised that the spare repeater is reprogrammed for the new frequencies.

Ross organised our QRZ representation (ZL1ROD call sign on QRZ.com) – have a look at it and tell Ross if any changes or improvement is required.

Sometime in April I learned about how Mike was supporting Gavin in procuring a new rig (IC-7300) including tuner and antenna. That made me very happy and proud because this is exactly the spirit I want for our Club – everybody is helping everyone – GREAT!

June was a great month. Our Mailing-list sprung into life and we got the first subscriptions. A great idea and tool to quickly reach all those who want to stay at the pulse of our Club.

We got 1 new Club member – Bert Toomey from Warkworth. This is great!

It was the first time we met Bert Toomey and Bert joined our Club after attending his first meeting. He also brought and donated 3 of his great old homebrew radios.



I would like to thank all those who regularly attend our 730-net meetings. In particular I want to mention Gavin, Alan and John (ZL1BDY) who attend every Thursday and doing so for a long time. John usually gives us all the news from around other Clubs and HAM activities.

I encourage everyone to participate if possible. – It is Thursdays at 19:30 on 147.300MHz.

Congratulations to Gavin who got engaged in August. Unfortunately this could mean that Gavin is soon moving QTH (going to Bay of Island) and might not be able to join our meetings in Wellsford.

September was a very quiet month regarding HAM activities and HAM news so nothing to report there.

In late October Alan got a certificate for being a 70 years member with the OTC (old timer club). That is a very remarkable achievement and we are proud to have Alan as our Club member.

With Gary we now have another member who is interested into morse code communication. Gary is now even a member of the straight key club.

Thanks to Mike our repeater was working very well throughout the year and I got statements from several HAMs that it worked at its best and like never seen before (strong signal and good quality).

Sadly I had to learn about Andrew who will stop his work as Secretary due to job commitments. To make things worse (or better) this also coincided with my own decision to resign from my office as President because of expected travel overseas and other life changing commitments for 2019.

Neither Andrew nor myself would be able to guarantee our presence for the 2019 meetings and therefore we think it is time to let someone else run the Club. A fresh breeze is always a good thing and we are looking forward to see our Club having new executives.

Please do not forget about our members who stay in the background most of the time.

Not being able to come to the meeting they still support us one way or another. I am talking about Andrew-ZL1ACP, Cecil-ZL2BCB, John-ZL1BEY, Rob-ZL1RD, Ron-ZL1RON, Rowan-ZL1UIS, John Seakins-ZL1BDY and many more.

I am grateful because they are loyal to our Club although being away. So let me send out our Best Wishes and **73** wherever they are at the moment!

And in the name of all – Thank you for bringing new acquisitions to the meetings so we can admire and scrutinise them with envy eyes.



This year we actually had a December meeting and we also had our traditional Christmas Lunch at the RSA in Warkworth on Friday 14th December.

We started gathering at 11:30, had some good talks and then a small lunch at 12:30.



We got 8 people at the table! : Mark, Richard, Mike, Alan, Ken, Bert and Luis (left to right).



Luis was visiting Paul on a trip from Spain and was keen to meet a bunch of NZ radio amateurs.

By now, the end of the year, we have 2 new ideas floating around: To have an HF net and a CW practise sked. Although I won't have an office to drive these motions I would like to encourage everyone to make this happen because it will raise our popularity.

The HF net would also enable John S. and Gavin to keep in contact with us from the far North.

Throughout the year we had very nice entertainment and education sessions provided by Alan who took on his Education and Entertainment role very seriously and professionally.

We also enjoyed many interesting talks, discussions and members' presentations.

What I really love about our Club is that every member is doing something for us and offers help. Everyone is somehow involved and this is nice!

Thanks everybody for being part of our great Club – The Rodney Amateur Radio Club

OUTLOOK 2018

My Vision and Plans for 2019

The Club as it is right now (status quo) runs very well.

We have a great web representation, a mailing list and a super repeater.
Our members make a great pool of skills, knowledge and experience.

I would like to leverage all that and keep moving and improving the way we just did in 2018.

The only thing we have to improve is getting more new members.
The more people we are the better we get and I would like to see us grow.

The already mentioned HF-net and morse code practise skeds might be some easy first steps in that direction.

Watch that space and let's do whatever is doable!

We are a great Club!

Thank you all for your support and your trust.

73 and a successful 2019

Paul Kaufmann – ZL1PAK
President of the Rodney Amateur Radio Club, Branch #71 NZART